Leisha Bajaj
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Data scientist focused on predictive modeling, feature engineering, and building interpretable data systems. Skilled in statistical inference and transforming raw data into insights that inform strategic decision-making.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Informatics, University of Washington Seattle — Graduating June 2027

- Minor in Business Administration
- Annual Dean's List 2023–24 & 2024–25; GPA: 3.8

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, SQL, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Svelte, Typescript
Tools & Libraries: Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, Altair, Matplotlib, Power BI, Pandas, Excel, GitHub, Figma, React
Techniques: Regression Analysis, Feature Engineering, Data Cleaning, Unit Testing, Model Evaluation, Statistical Inference
Certifications: ServiceNow Associate Business Process Analyst, ServiceNow Business Process Consultant

EXPERIENCE

Business Analyst Intern, NuTaste Food and Drink Labs — July 2025 – September 2025

- Built predictive Power BI dashboards to forecast SKU profitability, improving financial accuracy by 22% and supporting supply chain decisions
- Optimized asset categorization and prepared data infrastructure for AI automation, increasing tracking accuracy by 25%
- Developed detailed data flow specifications that strengthened analytics pipelines and improved data integrity

Technical Intern, Hexaware Technologies — July 2024 – September 2024

- Applied Agile methodology in daily stand-ups and sprints to streamline data delivery
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to identify automation opportunities using ServiceNow, cutting manual ticket sorting by 20%
- Used analytical feedback loops to improve project milestone mapping and documentation quality

PROJECTS

Analysing Chocolate Ratings — December 2024

- Created to analyze how ingredient origins and economic factors influence consumer chocolate ratings
- Built and evaluated regression models predicting ratings from cacao percentage, bean origin, and GDP data ($R^2 = 0.81$)
- Cleaned and transformed data with pandas, improving interpretability and reducing noise
- Visualized feature importance and correlations to guide sourcing insights for producers

UK Economic Analysis — March 2024

- Conducted to examine links between post-COVID socioeconomic recovery patterns and public health outcomes
- Cleaned and merged multi-year UK mortality datasets (500,000+ records) for consistent time-series analysis
- Aggregated weekly data into quarterly trends, uncovering 7.6% variance in death rates post-COVID
- Built Altair dashboards visualizing GDP-mortality correlations to support data-driven policy evaluation

Custom Search Engine — February 2024

- Built to improve information retrieval from large unstructured text datasets
- Built a Python-based TF-IDF search engine using an inverted index to rank document relevance across 100+ files
- Enhanced accuracy by 35% and reduced query times by 40% through optimized tokenization and filtering
- Ensured reliability through 98% PyTest coverage and automated validation

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Accessibility Designer/Developer, Wordplay — April 2024 – Present

- Designing and developing UI for accessibility per WCAG standards, improving usability for 150+ users
- Educating students at OpenWindow School on creating inclusive learning materials

Research Collaborator, ASILI Lab — January 2026 – Present

- Contribute to applied cybersecurity research and support experimental design, evaluation, and documentation
- Submitted findings to ACM CHI, Richard Tapia, and GROUP conferences

Mentor, TechXperience Hackathon, FearLess Hackathon — April, October 2025

- Guided students on defining problem spaces and building accessible prototypes